

# Sales Playbook

## Scenario Overview and Context

You're a hospice sales representative meeting for the first time with the Director of Nursing (DoN) at a Skilled Nursing Facility (SNF) that already has a preferred hospice provider. Your primary aim is to establish credibility, understand their current hospice-related needs and challenges, and secure a follow-up meeting. The focus should be on building trust and demonstrating an ethical approach, aligned with the Spartan Method pillars of discipline, empathy, and strategy.

## Step-by-Step Actionable Strategies

### Preparation

1. Research the SNF and DoN: Understand the facility's size, type, patient demographics, and any recent news or changes in leadership. Use LinkedIn or the facility's website to learn more about the DoN's professional background.
2. Understand Current Trends: Be knowledgeable about trends in hospice care, particularly within SNFs. This includes understanding common discharge challenges and standard practices.
3. Prepare Materials: Have concise, informative brochures ready, focusing on your hospice's unique value propositions, but keep these only as supportive material.

### Meeting Execution

#### Arrival and Introduction

- Arrive at least 10 minutes early for the meeting.
- Dress professionally and carry a positive, approachable demeanor.

#### Building Rapport

1. Ice Breaker: Start with a non-business related, observational comment to set a relaxed tone.
  - "I noticed your facility has beautiful landscaping—do you find it offers a therapeutic view for the residents?"
2. Understand Their Role: Show genuine interest in the DoN's role and experience.
  - "I'd love to hear more about your role here and any unique aspects of your facility that you believe make it stand out."

## Discovery Phase

### 1. Ask About Current Provider:

- "How has your experience been with your current hospice provider?"
- "What do you consider their strongest attributes, and where do you think there might be room for improvement?"

### 2. Explore Discharge Challenges:

- "What are some of the typical challenges you face when discharging patients to hospice care?"
- "How does your current provider assist with reducing hospital readmissions?"

### 3. Assess Needs and Pain Points:

- "Are there any areas related to hospice care where you feel additional support could be beneficial to your team or your patients?"

## Positioning For a Follow-Up

### 1. Introduce Your Values:

- "Our approach to hospice care is deeply rooted in collaboration and empathy. We focus on creating seamless transitions and reducing stress for both staff and patients."

### 2. Suggest a Follow-Up:

- "I would love the opportunity to dive deeper into how we can specifically support your team with these challenges. Could we schedule a follow-up meeting to explore this further?"

## Meeting Close

- Thank the DoN for their time and recap a key point they mentioned to show attentiveness.
- Provide your contact details and offer to send them any additional information that might be helpful.

## Specific Talking Points and Scripts

- Introductions: "It's a pleasure to meet you, [DoN's Name]. Thank you for taking the time to discuss hospice care today."
- Understanding Current Provider: "How do you currently work with hospice care partners, and what improvements are you looking for in these partnerships?"
- Discussion of Value: "We believe in streamlining communication and processes to make transitions as smooth as possible. How important is this to your team?"
- Follow-Up Meeting: "To better tailor our support to your needs, could we set aside some time in the coming weeks to discuss potential collaborative efforts?"

## Key Takeaways and Success Metrics

- Establish Trust: Demonstrating a genuine interest in their needs and challenges to build trust.
- Understand Current Needs: Gather specific information about current hospice provider performance and discharge challenges.
- Secure Follow-Up: Successfully arrange a follow-up meeting as a result of demonstrating value and understanding.
- Success Metrics:
  - Feedback from the DoN on the meeting's value.
  - A confirmed date and time for a follow-up meeting.
  - An articulated interest from the DoN in exploring alternative hospice care support.

By following this playbook, you'll be well-positioned to establish a relationship based on trust and empathy, setting the stage for potential future partnerships.

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